discussion, you'll get to know Spring Cloud Kubernetes and its primary use cases. Finally, I'll expand on configuration and secrets management for production workloads on Kubernetes, and you'll learn how to implement that using Kustomize.

NOTE The source code for the examples in this chapter is available in the Chapter14/14-begin and Chapter14/14-end folders, containing the initial and final states of the project (https://github.com/ThomasVitale/cloud-native-spring-in-action).

14.1 Configuring applications on Kubernetes

According to the 15-Factor methodology, configuration is anything that changes between deployment environments. We started working with configuration in chapter 4 and since then have used different configuration strategies:

- *Property files packaged with the application*—These can act as specifications of what configuration data the application supports, and they are useful for defining sensible default values, mainly oriented to the development environment.
- *Environment variables*—These are supported by any operating system, so they are great for portability. They're useful for defining configuration data depending on the infrastructure or platform where the application is deployed, such as active profiles, hostnames, service names, and port numbers. We used them in Docker and Kubernetes.